

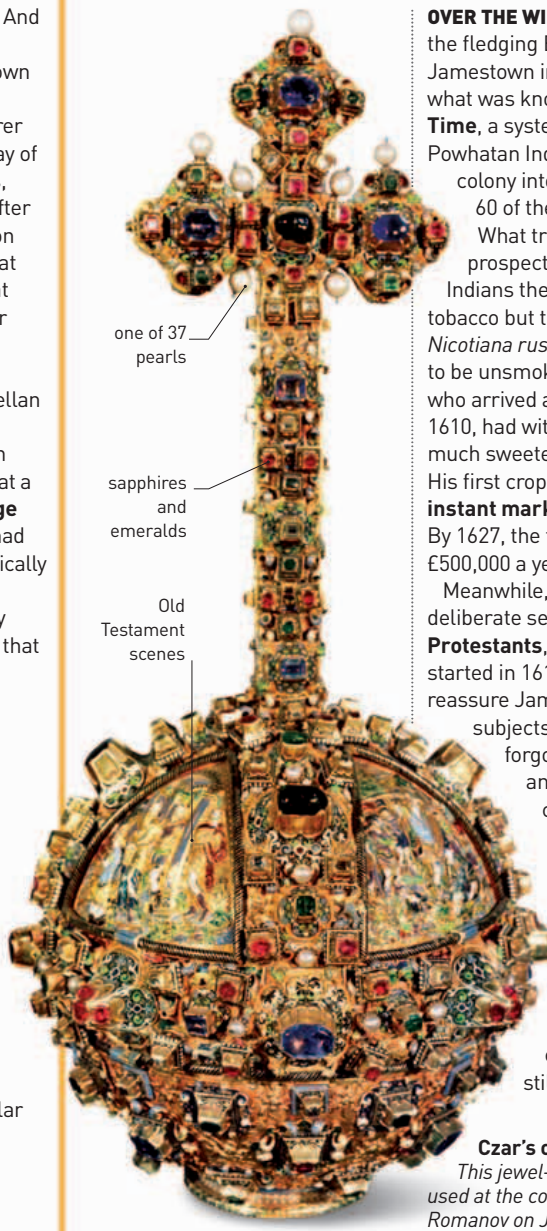


Tully Castle in County Fermanagh, Northern Ireland, was built in 1619 for Sir John Hume, a Scottish "planter," or settler.

to as the "King James Bible". And it was only in the early 19th century that it came to be known as the Authorized Version.

In June 1611, English explorer **Henry Hudson**, then in the pay of a group of English merchants, was abandoned by his crew after spending an arduous winter on the southern shore of the great bay in **northwest Canada** that bears his name. Hudson was searching for a northwest passage to Asia. Just as Magellan had discovered a route to the Pacific around the tip of South America, so it was believed that a comparable **northern passage** must exist. The search for it had sparked one of the most heroically futile episodes in global exploration, a series of mostly English endeavors from 1576 that revealed only unnavigable, ice-choked, dead-ends.

Control of **the Sound**—the narrow waterway between **Denmark** and **Sweden** at the mouth of the Baltic—was a central preoccupation in the continuing Scandinavian struggle for supremacy in the Baltic. In 1611, Sweden, determined to end Denmark's stranglehold on this vital waterway, began what became known as the **Kalmar War**. The result, in 1613, was inconclusive, the Dutch and England in particular supporting the Swedes once a Danish victory threatened. Future conflict was, in effect, merely postponed.



OVER THE WINTER OF 1609–10, the fledgling English colony at Jamestown in Virginia endured what was known as the **Starving Time**, a systematic attempt by the Powhatan Indians to starve the colony into submission. All but 60 of the 500 colonists died.

What transformed its prospects was **tobacco**. The Indians themselves cultivated tobacco but the native strain, *Nicotiana rustica*, was so harsh as to be unsmokeable. John Rolfe, who arrived at Jamestown in 1610, had with him seeds of the much sweeter *Nicotiana tabacum*. His first crop, in 1612, found an **instant market** in London. By 1627, the trade was worth £500,000 a year.

Meanwhile, in **Ireland** the deliberate settlement of **Protestants**, many from Scotland, started in 1613. It was intended to reassure James I's Scottish subjects that he had not forgotten their interests and to "pacify" and convert the rebellious **Catholic** population of Ireland. Its results were generally only to inflame religious passions and, by creating a Catholic underclass, to create tensions that still slumber today.

Czar's orb

This jewel-encrusted orb was used at the coronation of Mikhail Romanov on July 1613.



The title page of *Don Quixote*, part one of which was published in 1605, and part two in 1615. It remains a cornerstone of European literature.

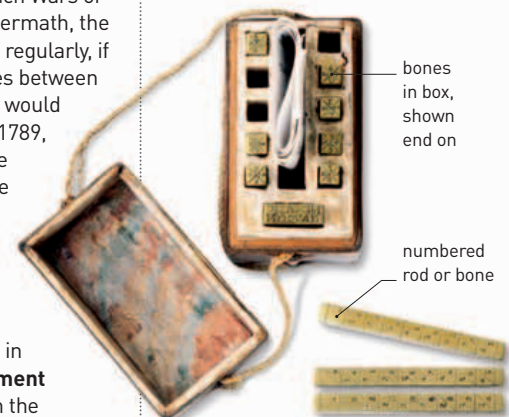
100,000 THE ESTIMATED NUMBER OF EUNUCHS EMPLOYED BY THE MING DYNASTY IN CHINA

IN STARK CONTRAST TO ENGLAND, where parliamentary authority would progressively increase throughout the 17th century, the influence of **France's** legislative assembly, the **Estates-General** withered almost entirely. During the crises of the French Wars of Religion and their aftermath, the Estates-General met regularly, if ineffectually: six times between 1560 and 1614. But it would not meet again until 1789, by which point France would be on the verge of revolution.

By 1615, China was grappling with financial crisis and social breakdown. There were **tensions** in the **Chinese government** over conflict between the scholars of the Donglin Academy (literally, "the Eastern Grove Academy") in eastern China, and the court eunuchs—particularly the notoriously capricious and

cruel Wei Zhongxian. With the semiretirement of the Wanli emperor, Wei Zhongxian had assumed personal control of the government. The Donglin scholars, adherents of the moral imperatives of Confucianism, objected to the self-glorification and extravagance of the eunuchs. By 1624, Wei Zhongxian had ensured the execution of the leading Donglin academics.

Meanwhile, the **Dutch** started to settle **North America**. In 1615, the Dutch cemented their 1609 claim to the region of present-day Albany by building Fort Nassau at the same site. In 1625, they would build a further settlement at the mouth of the Hudson River, **New Amsterdam**. Dutch colonial settlement would, however, dwindle by the end of the 17th century.



Napier's Bones

This is an abacus created by John Napier around 1615, which used numbered rods in order to simplify multiplication.

April War of Kalmar: Swedish-Danish conflict for control of the Baltic (to 1613)

1612 Tobacco cultivation begins, Virginia, North America

January 20, 1613 Sweden pays vast ransom for return of fortress of Ålvsborg, on the frontiers with Denmark

1612 First English East India Company factory in India, Surat

1612 Portuguese transport approximately 10,000 slaves a year from Angola to Brazil

1612 Poles forced to retreat from Russia

February 21, 1613 Mikhail Romanov elected czar of Russia (crowned in July)

1613 Protestant "plantation" (settlement) of Ireland begins

1614 Scottish mathematician John Napier (1550–1617) publishes logarithmic tables

1615 England sends first European ambassador to Mughal court

1614 Romanovs defeat Cossacks at Rostokino

1615 Internal conflict in China between Donglin party and corrupt eunuch party (to 1627)

1614 Christianity formally prohibited in Japan

1615 Samuel de Champlain reaches Lake Huron, one of the Great Lakes in North America